

Cloud Print

Google is believed to be developing a service enabling you to print a document from any device to any printer even in the absence of drivers

Deloitte predictions

Watch our interview with directors from Deloitte on our Playware DVD, as they chart out tech trends for the coming year

environments to be cost competitive, the implementations need to be fairly large-scale, something that one may not be inclined to consider, particularly when transitioning through a recovery phase.

Investments in application virtualisation could be worth postponing while the SaaS paradigm gains momentum. That is because SaaS could reduce the need for additional licensed software – and reduce the need to virtualise applications.

Overall, the larger your organisation, the more visible would be returns on a virtualisation investment, especially for large and larger-among-the-medium enterprises. However, vendors are also offering virtualisation solutions for smaller businesses.

ITNext believes that in a dynamically evolving market and technology scenario, a two-phased approach to virtualisation is the way to go: while need-based part-virtualisation projects should be rolled out for quick benefits, end-to-end, full-blown virtualisation projects may be evaluated from a long-term perspective.

5 Enterprise Mobility

Enterprise mobility solutions will give businesses much-needed dynamic flexibility in competitive market places

The scope of enterprise mobility ranges from intra-premise to inter-premise, and from intra-city to inter-city connectivity, and seamless access to enterprise applications. As enterprises strive to better compete in the marketplace, enterprise mobility is becoming a key differentiator.

Enterprise mobility is expected to register higher adoption levels across a wide range of verticals in 2010. The fact that laptop shipments will continue to grow at much higher rates than desktops, and smart phone shipments are already higher than PC sales, is a testimony to the ground being ready for enterprise mobility.

IT Next believes that enterprise mobility solutions will give businesses the much-needed dynamic flexibility in competitive market places. In particular, if you manage IT in businesses such as insurance, retail, logistics, transportation, manufacturing and healthcare, adoption of EM could bring in substantial business benefits, and also simplify

concerns such as location tracking and integrated view of inventory.

6 Unified Communication

The key advantage of UC lies in its ability to resolve a query in a given session. This increases productivity, and reduces resource and time costs

The commonly accepted key components of a UC solution are: e-mail, instant messaging, IP telephony, and presence, with video conferencing getting added to the suite.

The benefit is the integrated connectivity among different communication media and platforms like texting, voice and video. It allows the user to switch from one medium to another, literally at the click of a button.

You can use UC in your organisation for, say, a customer query resolution, within the span of a given session, to increase productivity and reduce resource and time costs. This is radically different from traditional communication which relies on a single medium, say email or telephony, and would typically involve multiple sessions spread over many days, even weeks, to close a query, business deal or customer complaint.

IT Next recommends UC, especially because the cost of implementation is not high, and given that UC leverages and integrates existing communication platforms like IP, hybrid PBX, e-mail and IM in the enterprise.

7 Green Technologies

Besides addressing the concern of rising energy costs, the focus on 'green' can contribute to CSR and sustainability initiatives

As an IT manager, you may have been witness to power and cooling requirements associated with IT rising to alarming proportions. You may even be directly affected if this expense now goes from the IT budget, as is the case for an increasing number of organisations.

A couple of years ago, a report by the Environmental Protection Agency of the US estimated that data center energy usage would nearly double by 2011 over 2006 levels if the then prevailing operating practices continued. While there is no

similar study for India, the rate at which data center adoption has grown over the past couple of years leads to the conclusion that the situation could be much worse.

If we take into account the fact that power supply situation in India is not dependable and that generators have become second way of life for most data centers, we're on a dangerous path...

You as an IT manager have a pivotal role to play here: you can use 'green' to effectively address the concern, while also contributing to your organisation's CSR and sustainability initiatives.

A good market development is that the cost of deploying green IT has come down significantly with IT vendors now shipping green IT as a mainstream rather than in a niche product.

IT Next is of the view that you are ideally positioned to be a green agent, and bring about the change in your organisation. Make the most of this opportunity to contribute, and save the environment.

8 Private Clouds

Get your vendor to package infrastructure, platforms, and applications together for greater economic benefit

A private cloud is an emulation of the public cloud in a controlled enterprise environment. Given the perceived advantages of (public) cloud computing, and the security and availability concerns surrounding it, a private or internal cloud holds the promise of offering the best of both worlds.

A private cloud, however, is not likely to be as cheap as a public cloud equivalent. Yet, if offered by your long-standing and trusted vendor or solution provider, IT Next suggests that you go for it. While virtualisation provides significant improvement in infrastructure utilisation rates, a good cloud management solution can drive utilisation even more.

A private cloud offering would make even more economic sense if the vendor is able to package infrastructure, platforms, and applications together in a seamless fashion as a robust solution. And, contrary to perceptions, private cloud offerings in 2010 will be useful and economically viable even for smaller businesses. IT Next suggests that as you take calculated